



Google previews Chrome OS, releases source code

Google gave a preview of its upcoming Chrome operating system in the US on November 19. Scheduled for launch in a year, the open source OS is intended for use on low-cost netbooks, but the final version will only be available pre-installed on new devices. Google has a number of prerequisites for hardware manufacturers to ensure Chrome's smooth running.

In essence, Chrome OS is a much-expanded version of Google's Chromium Web browser and almost all of its functionality is based around Web applications. Although the OS code is stored on the netbook itself, the applications it runs are all cloud-based—Gmail, Google Docs, and so on.



Not surprisingly, Google Chrome OS also relies upon a ubiquitous Internet connection, but most Google apps already support offline access via Google Gears. How much of a problem a Chrome OS netbook is when there's no Internet connection remains to be seen, but

it's impossible to imagine that this isn't a situation that Google hasn't already thought about.

Red Hat Virtualisation for heterogeneous servers

Red Hat has announced the availability of Red Hat Enterprise Virtualisation for Servers, the newest product set in the Red Hat Enterprise Virtualisation portfolio. Red Hat Enterprise Virtualisation for Servers is designed to enable pervasive adoption of virtualisation, with an end-to-end solution combining a standalone hypervisor and powerful virtualisation management.

Paul Cormier, executive vice president and president, products and technologies, Red Hat, said, "Red Hat Enterprise Virtualisation provides ISVs, IHVs and customers with the opportunity to seamlessly move applications and hardware platforms from bare metal computing to virtualised computing to cloud computing while maintaining certifications. We believe that Red Hat Enterprise Virtualisation, especially the management components, will allow customers to use virtualisation pervasively."

Red Hat Enterprise Virtualization for Desktops remains in private beta today and is expected to be made generally available in early 2010.

FOSS jobs portal launched

LUG@IITD community manager, Narendra Sisodiya, announced FOSS job board (<http://fossjobs.in>) on the 20th of November, '09. There was a high requirement of a job board for students and professionals who want to work on free and open source technologies. FOSSJobs.in is committed to provide, free of cost, job postings which are strictly related to FOSS. The website has a nice GUI to search jobs by category, by city and by company. You can also search for jobs by the type (freelance, work from home, full time, part time, volunteer). All updates on fossjobs.in are available on Twitter too (@fossjobsdotin).

Dell unveils Android-based Mini 3 smartphone

Dell has confirmed plans to enter the smartphone business. The company officially announced recently that it would sell its first smartphone in China in late November, followed by a launch in Brazil towards the end of the year. The much talked about new phone from Dell is called Mini 3 and uses Android as its OS. However, the PC manufacturer didn't disclose further technical details about the phone. Dell said it would distribute its new Mini 3 smartphones through China Mobile, the largest telecommunications company in the world with more than 500 million customers, and Claro, which serves more than 42 million people in Brazil as part of the America Movil network. The company said it chose Android because of its easy customisation, explaining, "Mobile operators like it because they can easily customise the operating system in order to make it work better with their wireless platforms."



Netweb unveils Tyrone Opslag flexible storage solution

Netweb Technologies—a server, storage and HPC solutions provider—has unveiled its modified flexible storage solution (FS2) for the broadcast and media industry that is expected to significantly change traditional SAN and NAS markets. Key features include scalability up to 384 TB, transfer speeds up to 2GB/s when used with InfiniBand, and input/output unification. FS2 can store more than 900 hours of uncompressed, high-definition 1080i video footage and 30,000 hours of uncompressed standard-definition (SD) video. Besides this, a GUI and Web based management system makes FS2 deployment easy and fast.